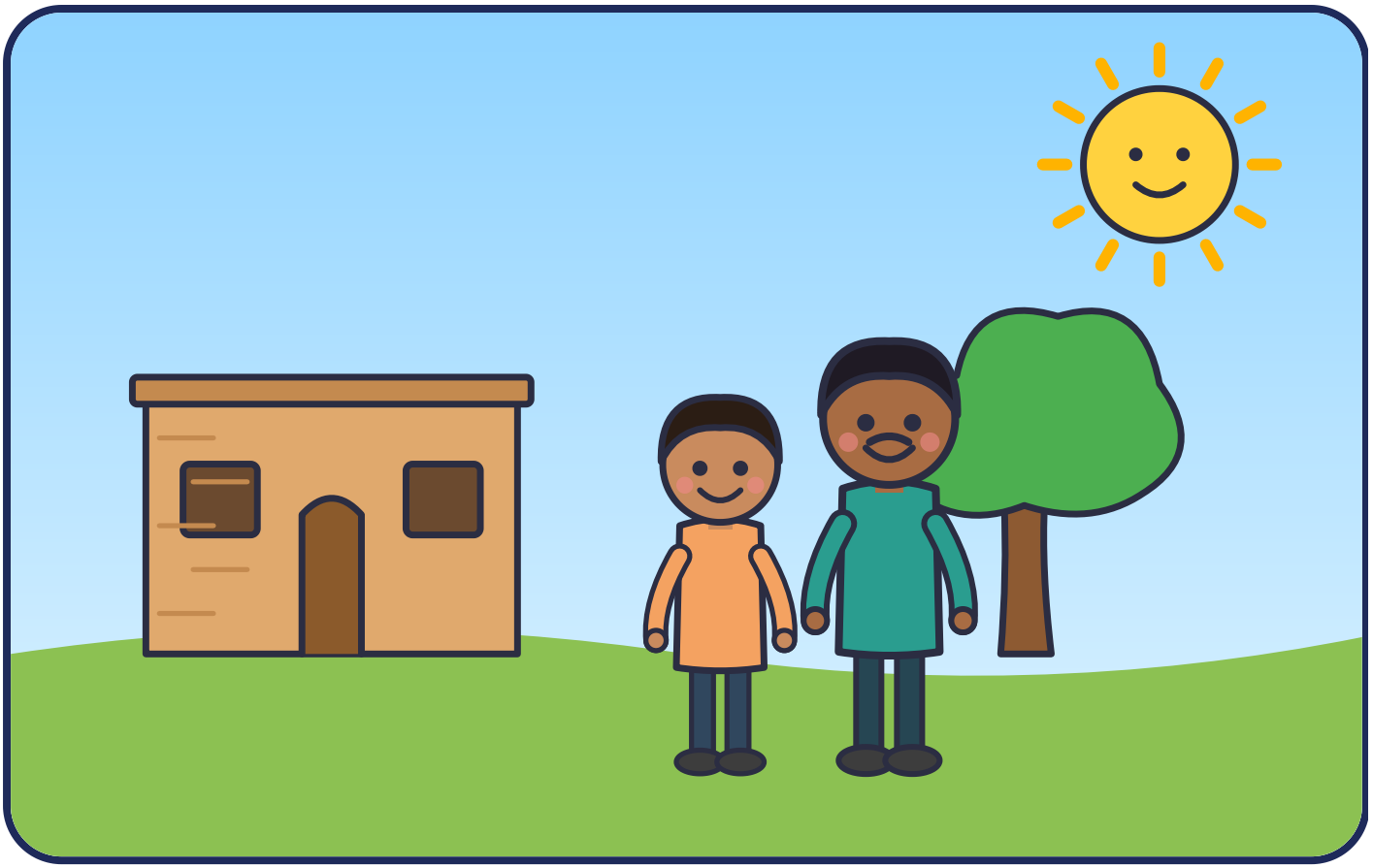
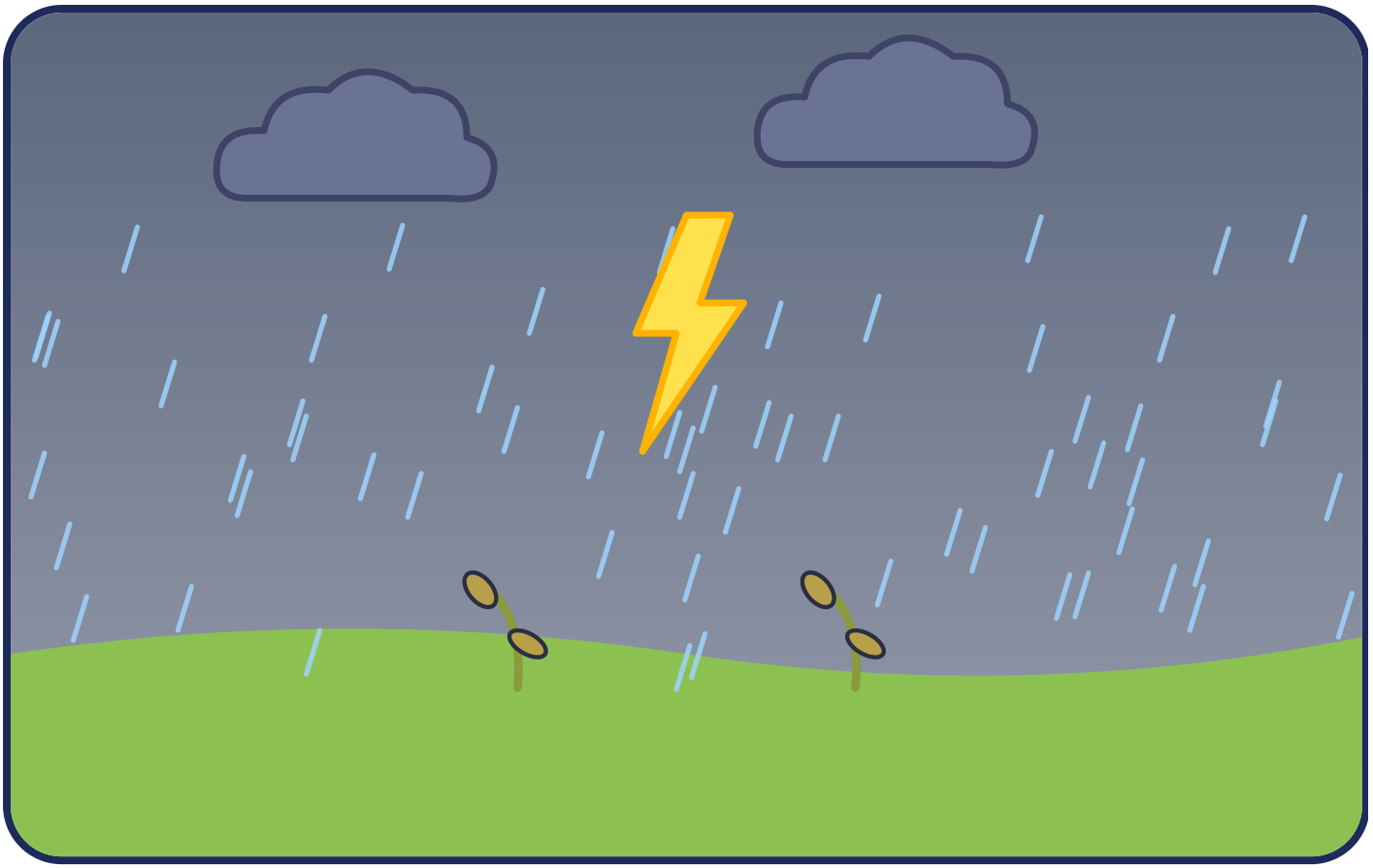


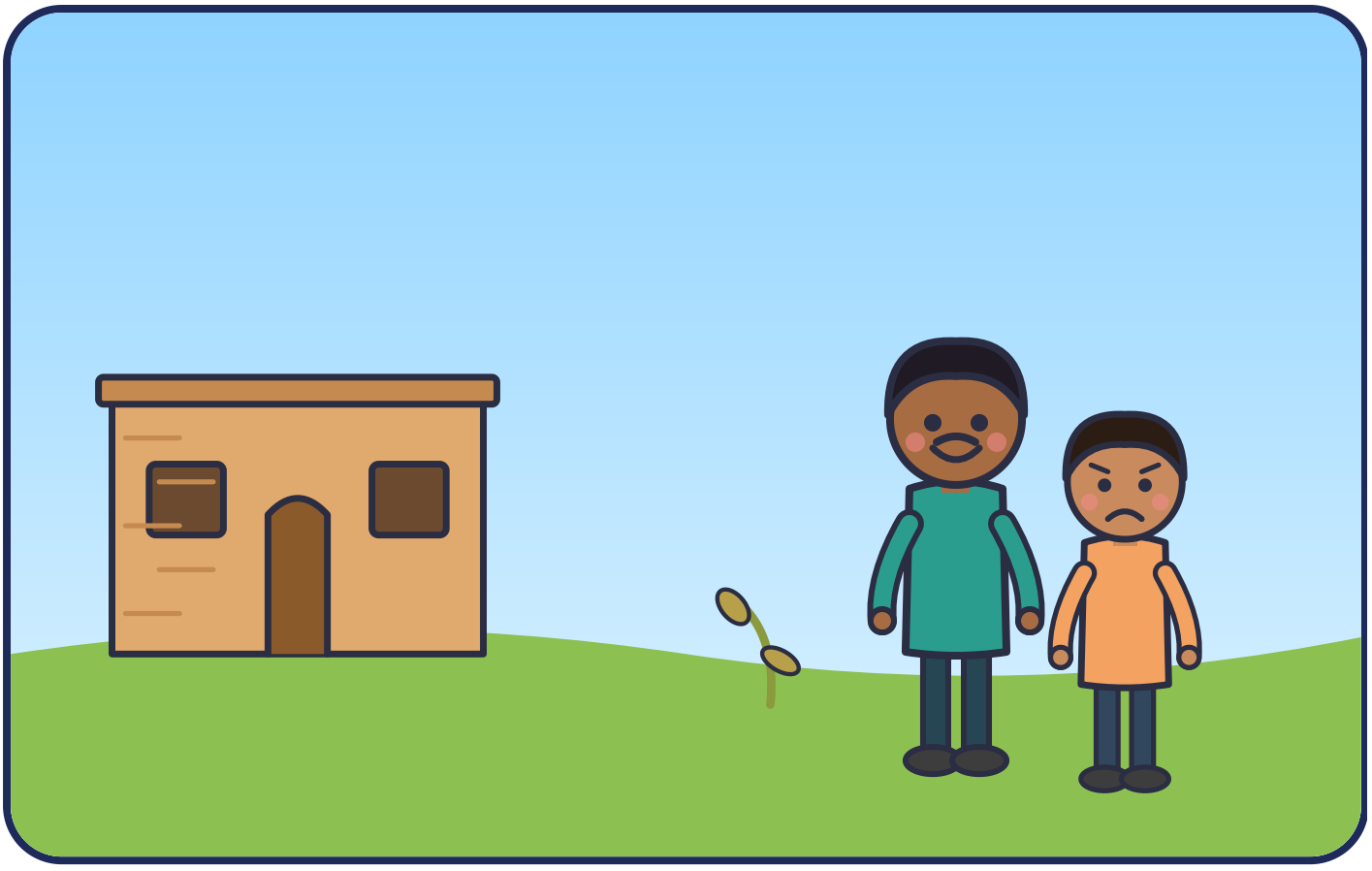
Youssef's Market Stall

English Mood Academy

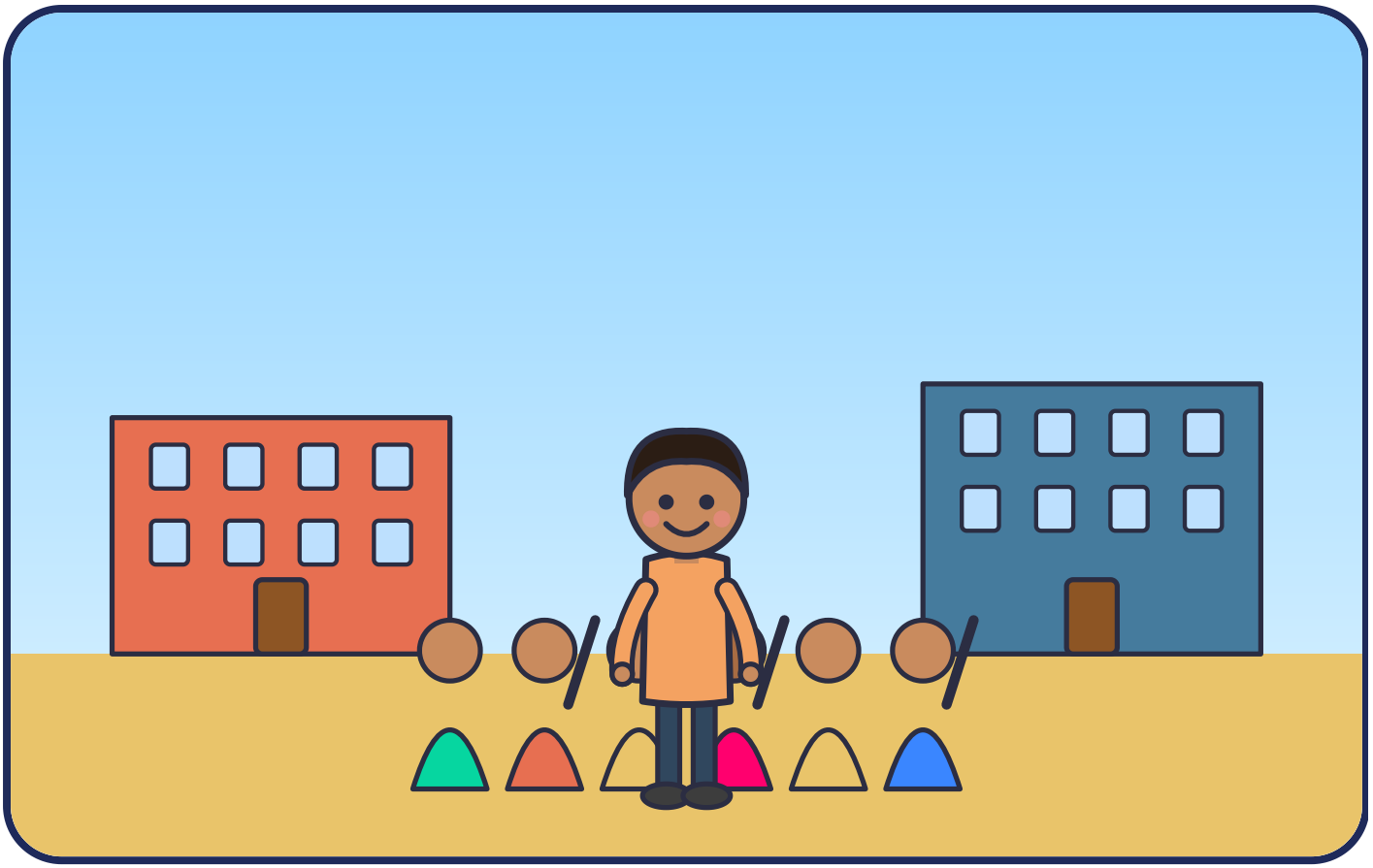
yellow = new words red = past verbs



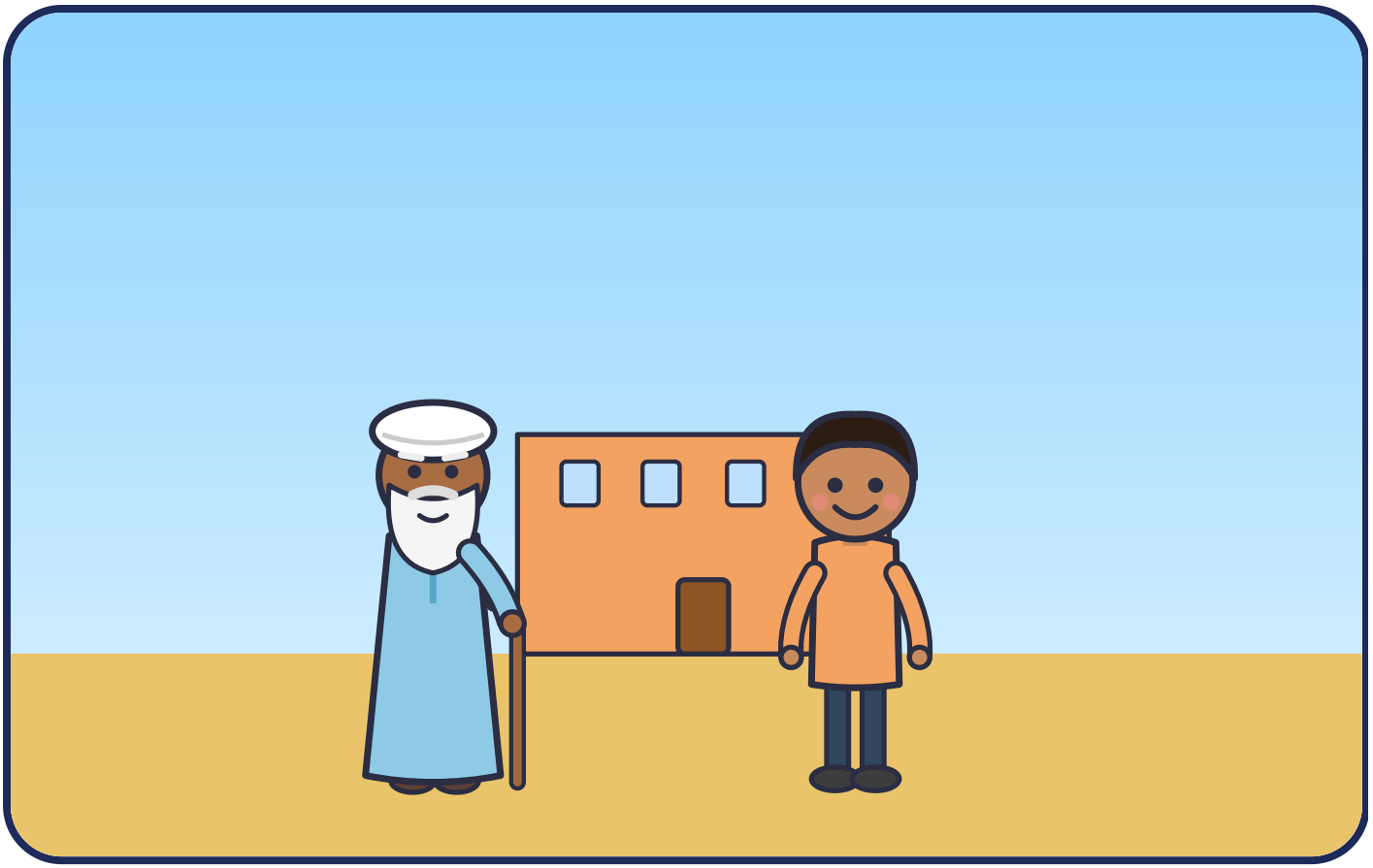
Youssef's family had a small farm near Fayoum. One spring, a **hurricane** of wind and rain **hit** the village. It was **disastrous**: **pests** ate the plants, and the family's **harvest** was very small.



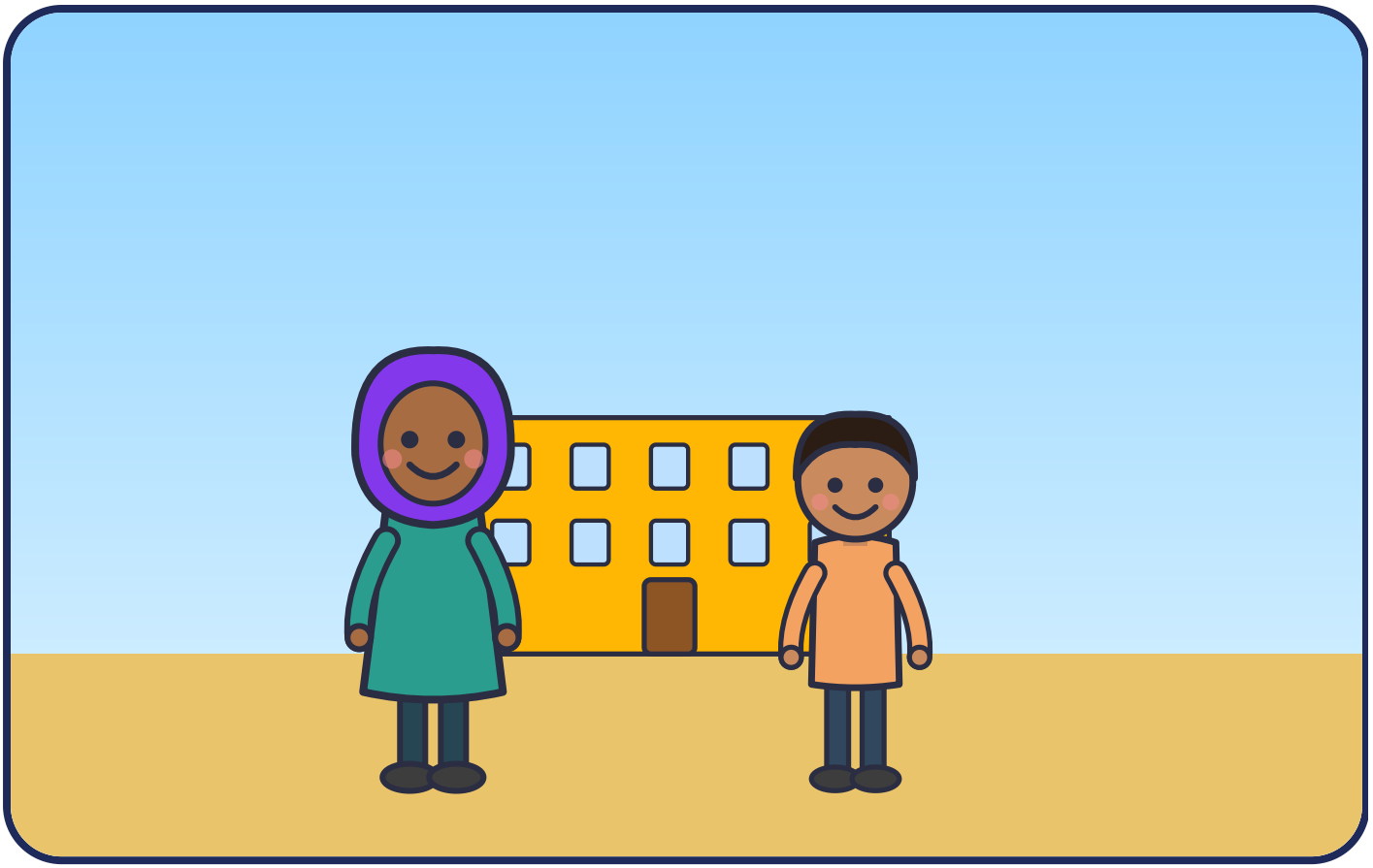
"There is a **shortage** of tomatoes this year," Dad said. "The **cost** of **fertilizer** went up, and our **wages** can't pay every **bill**." Youssef was **fed up**, but he had an idea.



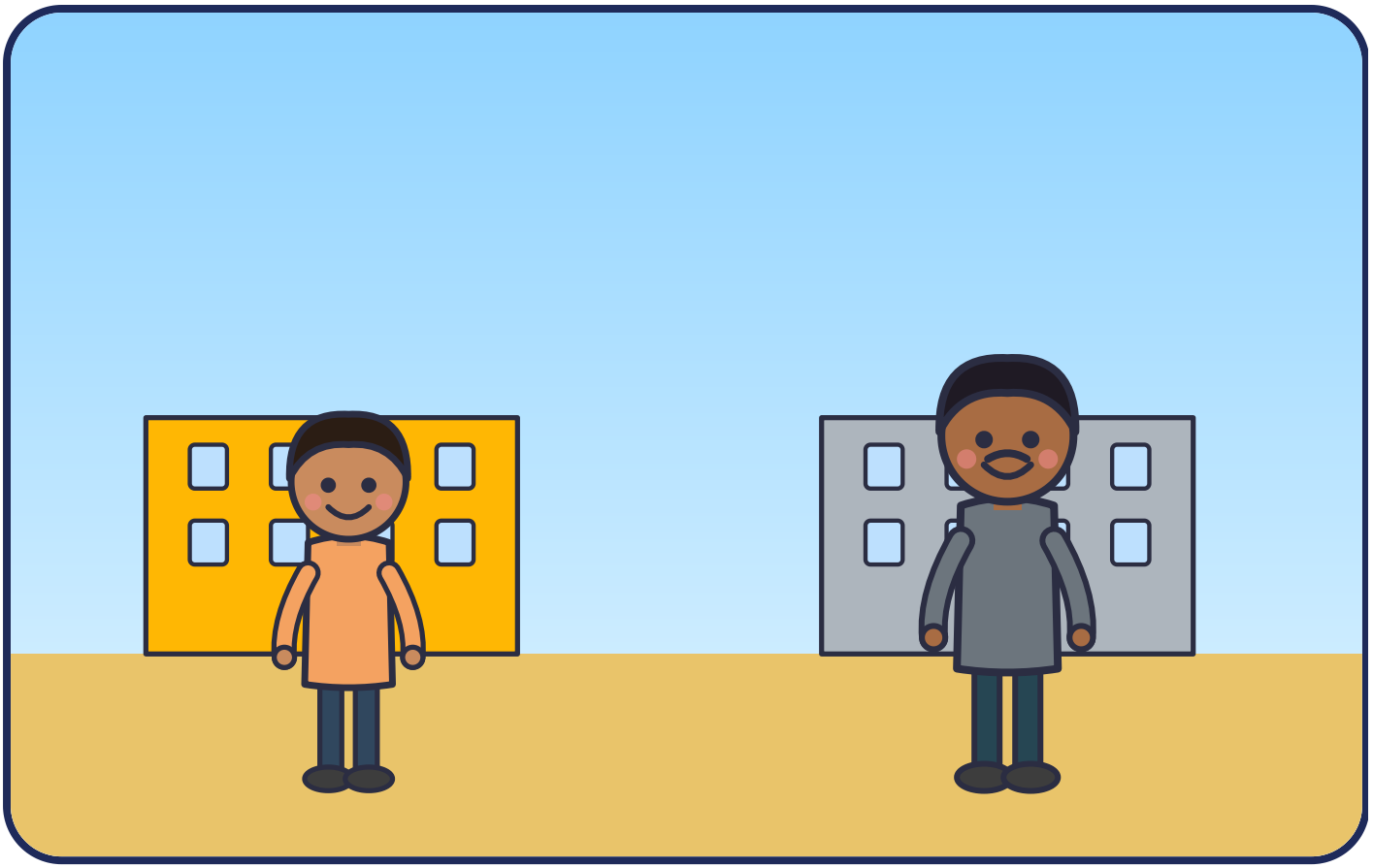
"Let's sell our honey at the Saturday market," Youssef **said**. "It is our best **possession**!" The market was a busy **venue**, full of **shoppers** and **consumers**.



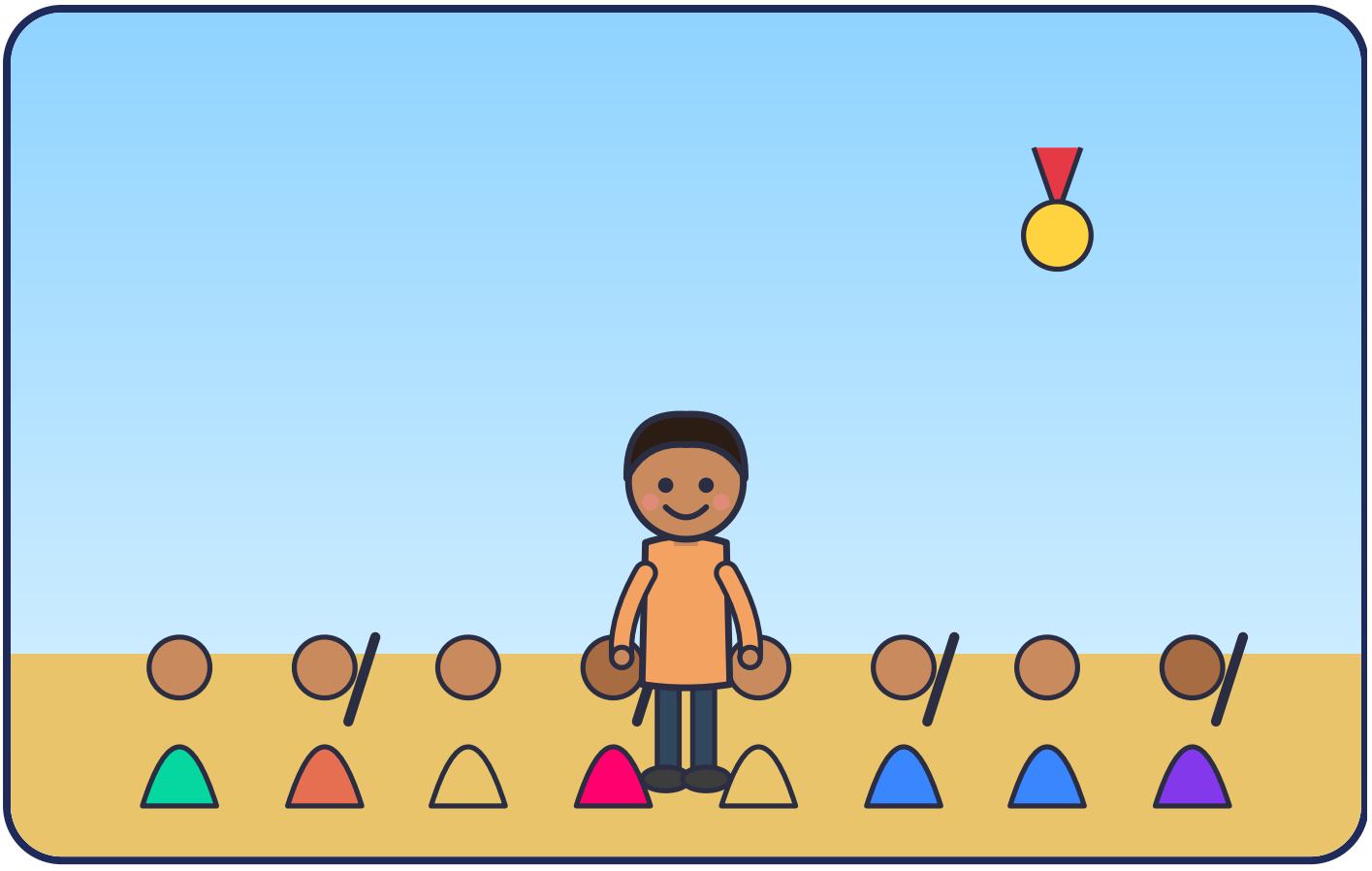
At first, nobody **bought** anything. Then an old man asked, "Can I **swap** my eggs for your honey?" Youssef smiled. "Long ago, people **bartered** like this, before **currency** existed."



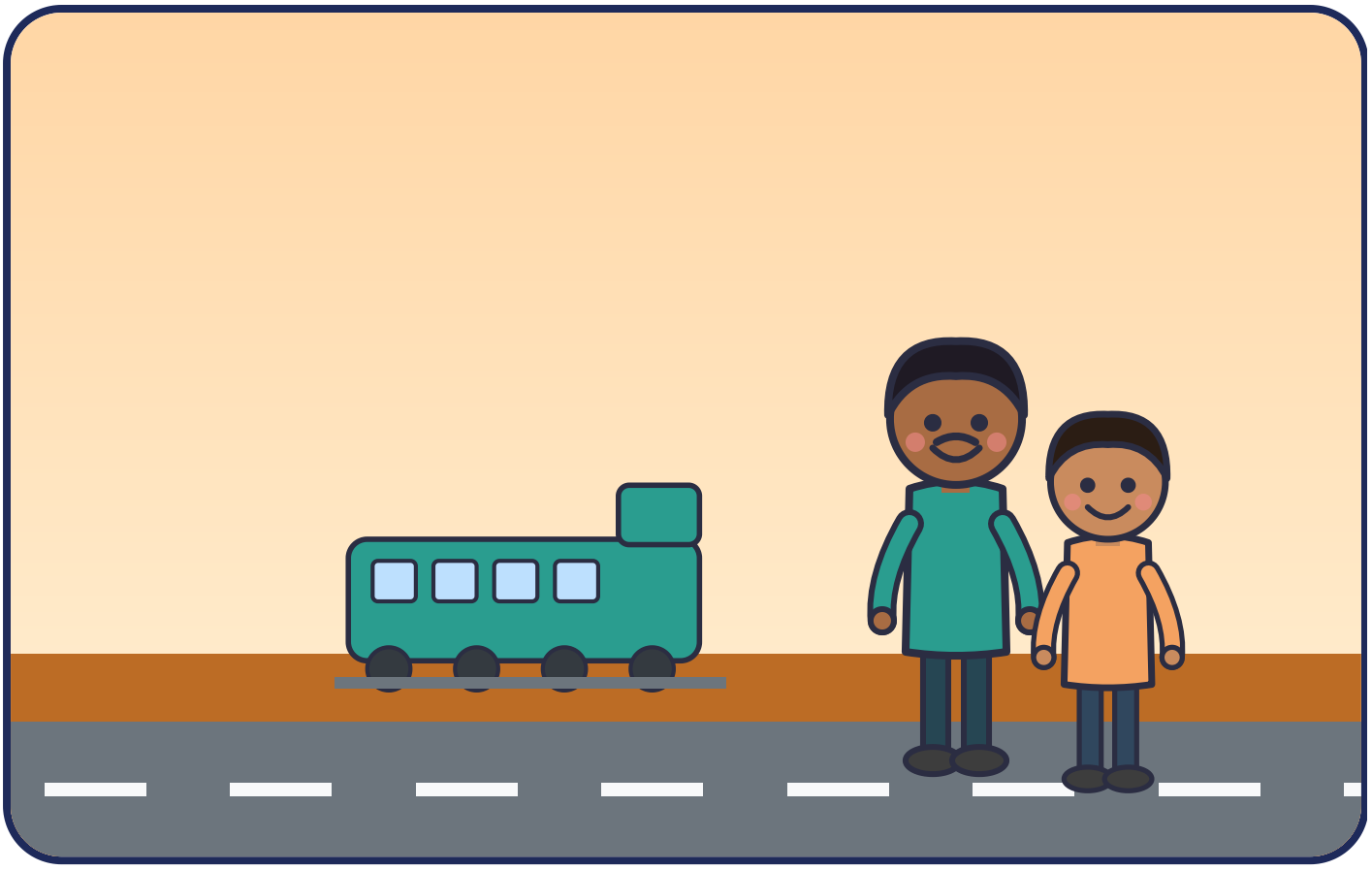
A rich woman **wanted** ten jars. She tried to **negotiate** a lower price. Youssef thought about the **value** of his honey and the **expense** of the jars. Finally, they agreed, and the **transaction** was done.



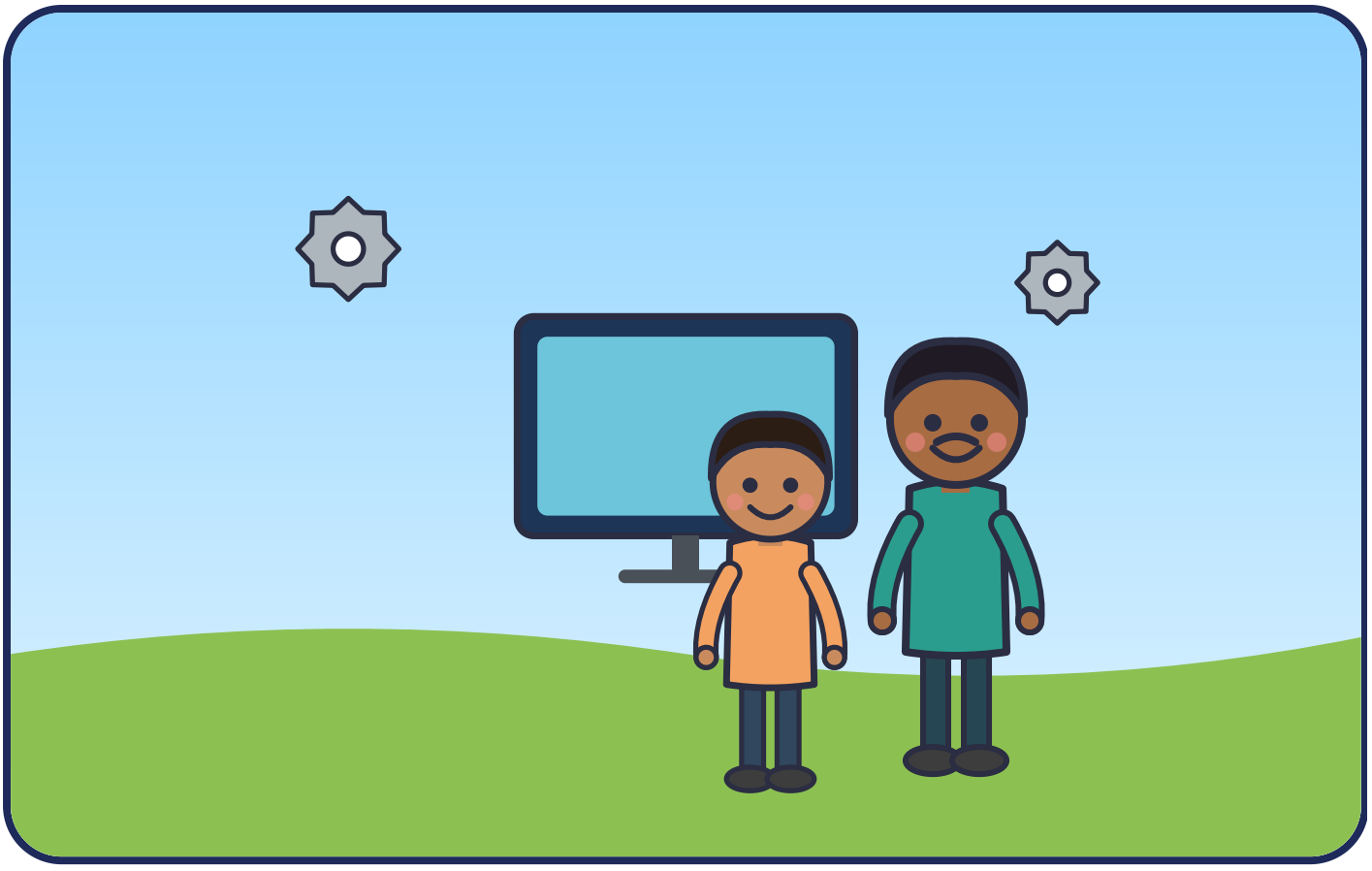
Next to his stall, a **competitor** sold cheap honey. "Low prices **tempt** shoppers," Youssef **thought**, "but quality is my first **priority**." He did not **reduce** his price.



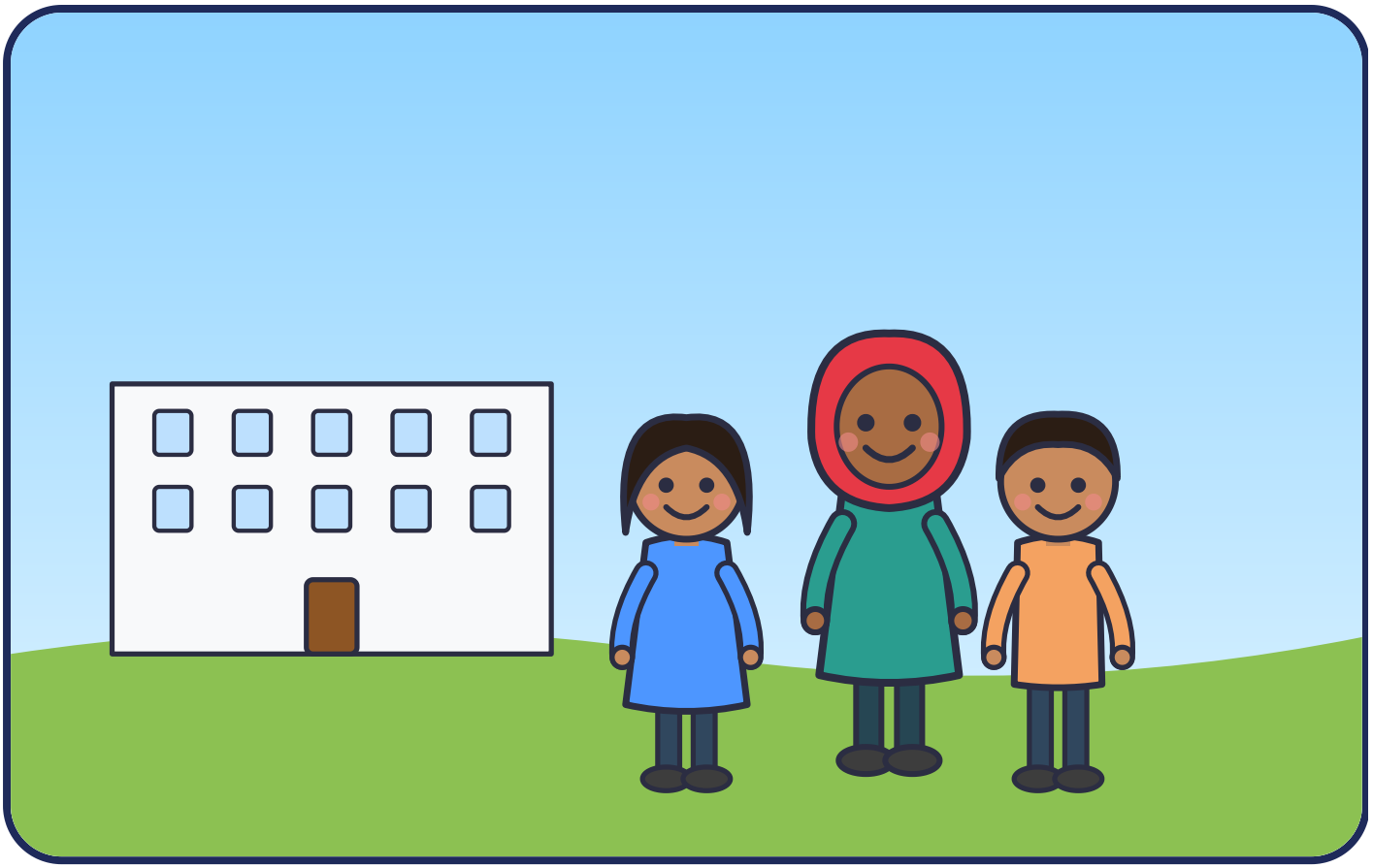
Soon, a shopper **tasted** the cheap honey. "This **stuff** is only sugar!" he shouted. People **increased** their orders from Youssef, and his **profit** began to **go up**.



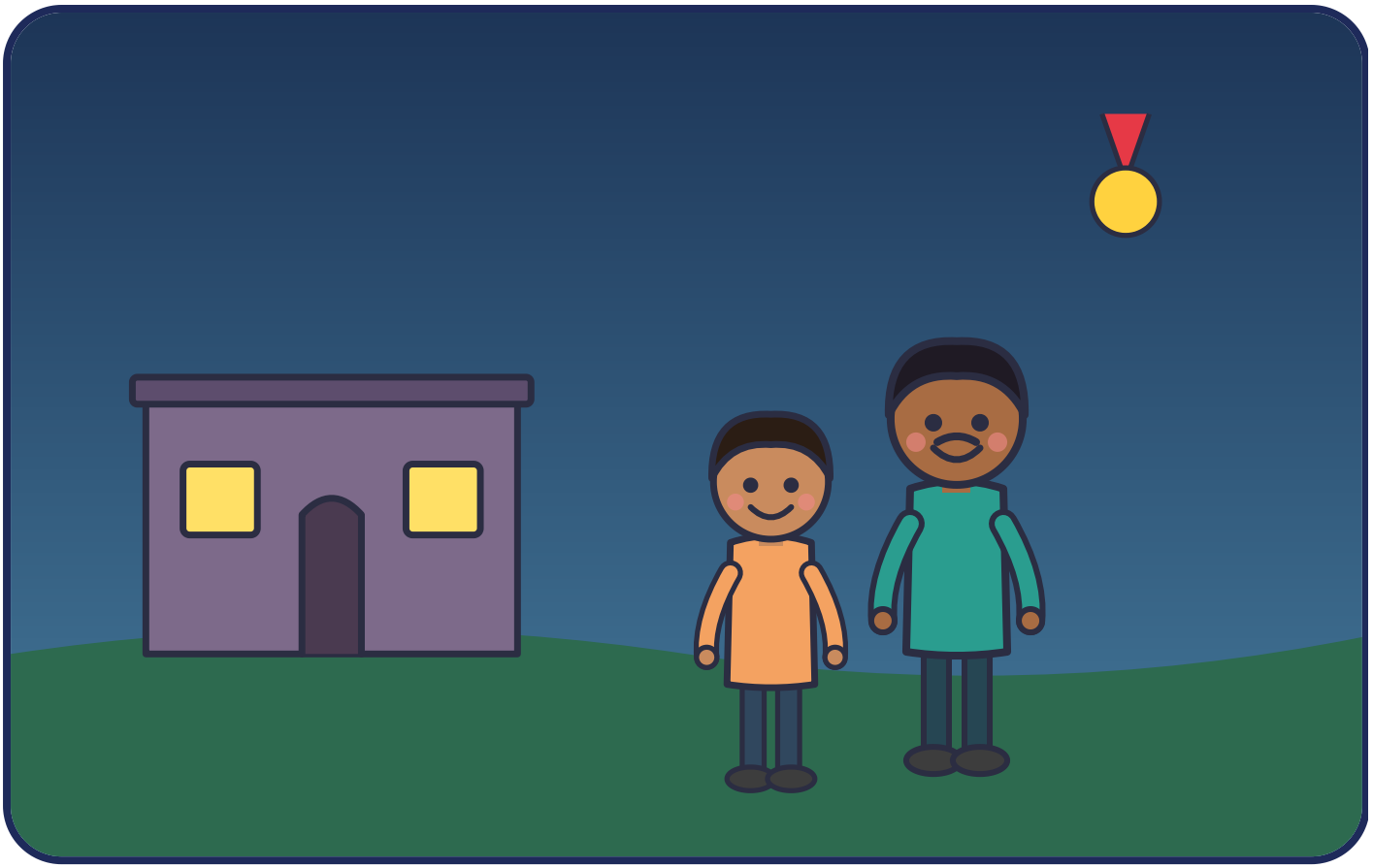
On the way home, a car hit the **bumper** of Dad's truck. It was only a **minor** accident, but it caused some **inconvenience**. "The driver will **pay for** the damage," Dad **said**.



With the money, Dad bought a small **gadget** from a **manufacturer** in Cairo. It **checked** every **component** of the soil and helped the family use the right **quantity** of water.



Youssef also paid the **tax** and gave money to fight **poverty** in the village. He paid for **vaccination** against **polio** for poor children. "Bad weather can **ruin** a farm," he said, "but hard work never makes hope **go down**."



That night, Youssef felt a warm **sensation** of pride. Every **potential** problem can have a solution. "You **deserve** this success," Dad **smiled**. Honest trade is always **convenient** for everyone.

The End 🍯

Honesty and quality are worth more than quick, cheap profit.

الأمانة والجودة أغلى من المكسب السريع الرخيص.

Words from the story

hurricane	إعصار	currency	عملة	pay for	يدفع ثمن (خطأ)
disastrous	كارثي	negotiate	يتفاوض	gadget	جهاز صغير
pest	آفة / حشرة ضارة	value	قيمة	manufacturer	شركة مصنّعة
harvest	حصاد / محصول	expense	مصروف / نفقة	component	مكوّن / جزء
shortage	نقص	transaction	معاملة (بيع أو شراء)	quantity	كمية
cost	تكلفة	competitor	منافس	tax	ضريبة
fertilizer	سماد	tempt	يُغري	poverty	فقر
wages	أجور	priority	أولوية	vaccination	تطعيم
bill	فاتورة	reduce	يقلل	polio	شلل الأطفال
fed up	زهقان / ضجران	stuff	أشياء / حاجات	ruin	يدمّر / يُفسد
possession	ملكية / ممتلكات	increase	يزيد	go down	ينخفض / يقل
venue	مكان (حدث)	profit	ربح	sensation	إحساس
shopper	متسوّق	go up	يرتفع / يزيد	potential	محتمل / مُمكن
consumer	مستهلك	bumper	مصد السيارة	deserve	يستحق
swap	يبادل	minor	بسيط / ثانوي	convenient	مناسب / مريح
barter	يقايض	inconvenience	إزعاج / مضايقة		

Past verbs

hit → **hit** * · say → **said** * · have → **had** * · buy → **bought** * · want → **wanted** · think → **thought** * · taste → **tasted** · check → **checked** · smile → **smiled**